



Board of Works January 7, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xNlvhUap_wo
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Target Category	muncie_city

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The regular meeting of the Muncie Board of Public Works and Safety was called to order on January 7th by the presiding officer [00:00:02](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - Members Present: Ted Baker, Linda Gregory, and Lilice (identified via election slate and roll call).
 - Presiding Officer: Ted Baker (elected as Board President).
 - Absent: None noted.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:07](#).
- **Election of Officers:** The board held its annual election of officers [00:00:38](#). A motion was made, seconded, and approved by voice vote to establish the following slate:
 - **Ted Baker:** President [00:00:44](#)
 - **Lilice:** Vice President [00:00:44](#)
 - **Linda Gregory:** Clerk Secretary [00:00:44](#)
- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes from the December 30th meeting were submitted, reviewed, and approved by voice vote [00:01:16](#).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:31 Register of Claims**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Craig Wright
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Craig Wright presented the register of claims, noting that the week's expenses primarily consisted of smaller claims focused on healthcare and utilities, alongside a few bond payments.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** A motion was made and seconded to approve claims totaling \$1,147,152. Approved by Voice Vote **00:02:12**.
- **00:02:31 Memorandum of Understanding: City of Muncie & Muncie Mission Ministries**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** The Mayor **00:02:35**
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The Mayor introduced a Memorandum of Understanding (MOU) with Muncie Mission Ministries aimed at supporting "The Hub" building housing multiple agencies that assist the homeless. Rising operating expenses made the facility difficult to sustain. To ensure continuous support for collaborative homelessness services, the city committed \$125,000 annually funded via EDIT (Economic Development Income Tax) dollars. The MOU spans a multi-year period effective from January 2026 through December 31, 2030 (5 years), designed to extend into future administrations. No strict limitations were placed on fund usage (permitting use for staffing, building maintenance, etc.).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None during this specific item.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Board members noted that formal board voting/signing was not legally required for this administrative MOU, but officially entered the document into the public record **00:04:50**.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:05:22 Rick Yenser** (Newsman / Author) addressed the board regarding the allocation of EDIT (Economic Development Income Tax) funds toward social services and charities. He questioned whether this aligned with the original intent of EDIT funds, which he recalled were traditionally designated for job creation, business infrastructure, and utilities. He raised concerns regarding visible homelessness (such as individuals living under river bridges) and questioned other city funding allocations, such as family navigators and the YWCA capital campaign. He urged the government to prioritize economic development initiatives that build jobs and the local economy **00:05:22**.
 - *Board Response:* The presiding officer offered brief perspective, noting that funding social services and community programs contributes to "quality of place," which is a primary factor for outside entities looking to bring jobs into the community **00:07:38**.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** None.
- **Adjournment:** Having no further business, the meeting was adjourned by the presiding officer [00:07:59](#).

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